

## Chapter 5

### The Solution

Throughout all the centuries, a distinctive character of God's people is their unbreakable will to resist the worship of idols. From Moses' anger against the golden calf at Mount Sinai, to Elijah and the seven thousand who have not bowed their knee to Baal, to Daniel and his companions refusing to worship Nebuchadnezzar's golden image, no matter how hopeless and dire the situation seems, God has always provided, will always provide a way out (2 Cor. 1:10).

### The Need for a Solution

Before we see the potential solution(s) to the mark of the beast for all of humanity, this matter is not to be taken lightly or dismissed, as the burden of the author for the solution is not merely for selfish survival during the great tribulation, which is to simply live on the earth for another three and a half years. No, far be it so, a solution that annuls the mark of the beast (its design and incentive) is able to change the eternal fate of all those still dwelling on earth when the great tribulation begins, and the mark of the beast appears.

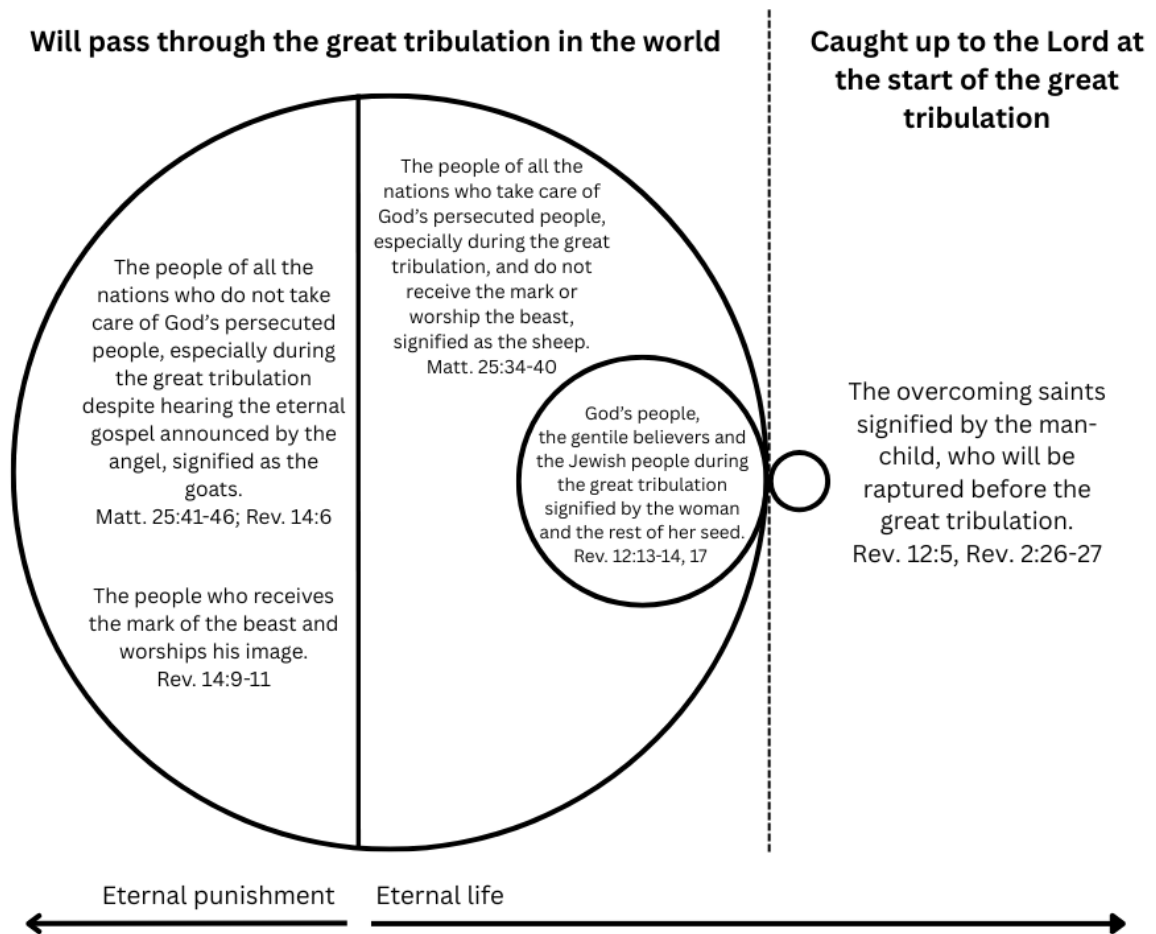
It is easy to overlook the severity of the mark of the beast with disingenuous clichés such as salvation as a guarantee to go to heaven, or all Christians will be raptured before the great tribulation. Upon inspecting the evidence found within the Bible, specifically the book of Revelation, we will see that there is a very great need for the survival of God's people and the inhabitants of the earth during the great tribulation, for the people to receive the eternal gospel (Rev. 14:6) and take care of God's suffering people during these three and a half years (Matt. 25:34-40), and for God's people to mature and grow in life under this intensified situation, as the Lord is seeking to gather all His people as those that are mature in life before He returns (Rev. 14:15-16, Matt. 13:3-8). The following is an extract of the footnotes of Revelation 14:14-16 concerning the gathering of the believers near the end of the great tribulation written by Witness Lee (1):

*The harvest of the earth is God's people on earth, the believers in Christ (1 Cor. 3:9). At His first coming to the earth, the Lord sowed Himself into His believers (Matt. 13:3-8, 24). All the believers since that time, who have received Him as the seed of life, have become God's crop on the earth. The first-ripe ones will be reaped as the firstfruits to God before the great tribulation, as indicated in 14:1-5. The majority will ripen with the help of the trials in the great tribulation and will be reaped, raptured, at the end of the great tribulation.*

*The Greek work for "ripe" literally means to be "dried", to be "dried" of all the earthly water. The suffering of the great tribulation, like the parching sun, will dry up the earthly waters from the believers who are left on the earth in the great tribulation, enabling the believers to ripen. The reaping here in 14:16 will take place after Antichrist forces people to worship him and his*

*image (14:9). Hence, it refers to the rapture of the majority of the believers, who are left on the earth to pass through the great tribulation.*

Hence, we see that only a minority of the believers will be raptured before the great tribulation, as in the chapter right before the appearance of the Antichrist, the False Prophet, and the mark, Satan as the great dragon (Rev. 12:9) was waging war against a women, who symbolises God's people as the Jews (who keep the commandments of God) and the Christians (who have the testimony of Jesus) in verse 17. We see that the man-child brought forth by the woman is caught up to God and to His throne, before Satan can devour this child, before the three and a half years of the great tribulation (Rev. 12:4-6), signifying the overcoming believers (the man-child) as a



minority of all of God's people (the women) will be raptured before the great tribulation, leaving the majority of God's people still on the earth to pass through the great tribulation for three and a half years (Rev. 12:14). After the man-child was raptured up and the dragon is cast down (Rev. 12:9), Satan will continue to persecute God's people, and to do that, he stood by the sand of the sea summoned the Antichrist (Rev. 12:18, 13:1), setting the stage for the mark of beast beginning Revelation chapter 13.

Additionally, the people dwelling on the earth during the great tribulation who are not yet believers will hear the preaching of the eternal gospel concurrent with the mark of the beast. When Christ returns at the end of the great tribulation (Matt. 24:29-30), He will gather all the people from all the nations before Him, like a shepherd who separates the sheep from the goats, setting the sheep on His right hand and the goats on His left (Matt. 25:31-33). The “sheep” and “goats” are the people of all the nations before the time of Christ’s return, with their conduct and actions toward God’s persecuted people during this time determining whether they will receive eternal life or eternal punishment (Matt. 25:46). Undoubtably, the people dwelling on the earth will need a means to survival without receiving the mark of the beast, to be able to somehow buy and sell the necessities for living, and additionally to sustain God’s persecuted people; to cloth, to heal, to visit, to shelter, and to provide food and drink to God’s persecuted people during the great tribulation (Matt. 25:34-40). It is implied that the people who are the “sheep” who took care of God’s people are those who did not receive the mark of the beast, as those who have the mark will share in the fate of the “goats” (Matt. 25:41; Rev. 14:9-11). Therefore, it is implied that the people on the earth will need (or have, because both Matthew chapter 25 and Revelation are written in the past tense) a means of economic survival without the mark of the beast.

There is no middle ground during the great tribulation, all people on earth will face the inevitable and unavoidable choice of submitting to the Antichrist and caring for the Antichrist’s interests, or receiving Christ and the gospel, and caring for Christ’s people; from their actions and conducts in that time, those who are not for the Lord are against the Lord (Matt. 25:41-46, 12:30). It is clear that the great tribulation is intended for the Christ’s believers on the earth to grow and mature in life before Christ’s return, and for the trialling of the people of the earth who are yet non-believers to determine if they are willing to receive the gospel (Rev. 14:6) and distinguish those who will side with God from those who will side with the Antichrist (Matt. 25:32-34)

## **The Requirements for a Solution**

Because of the all-inclusive nature and the global reach of the mark over all of humanity (Rev. 13:7, 16-17), any solution to the mark of the beast must ought to be all-inclusive in countering the mark’s sole incentive of permissioning the use of money, and be global, available to every tribe and people and tongue and nation, to the small and the great, the rich and the poor, and the freemen and the slaves. Therefore, the solution ought to be permissionless to use, and is universally available, accessible, and recognised by everyone for storing and transacting value; something most similar to gold in terms of its universal function as a store of value and medium of exchange.

## **Economic Survival & the Utility of Money**

To strike at the mark of the beast’s only point of failure, we have exposed that the Antichrist’s initial rise to power and authority over the whole world will most likely not be through global terror

and bloodshed, but through the control of global monetary systems. As Satan, being a master of commerce and business (cf. Ezek. 28:16) will hand over his power and great authority to the Antichrist (Rev. 13:2, 7) over the world and the world's systems (cf. Matt. 4:8-9), inclusive of the banking, financial, commercial, and monetary systems of the world. As such, cleverly and deceitfully disguising the Antichrist as a (charismatic and powerful) strong man who can take over and rule the world without firing a bullet. This is not to say that the Antichrist is peaceful, but instead appears to be only as a pretence, a man skilled in deception and ambiguities (Dan. 8:23-25). When his true colours are revealed, that man of lawlessness will also be known as the destroyer, Apollyon (Rev. 9:11), and he will do much destroying of the earth and of mankind and wage war against God's people (Rev. 13:7; Dan. 7:7, 8:23-25). It is human nature that we like to follow those we consider charismatic and successful; most certainly, the Antichrist will draw many to follow him even before showing his true colours and identity. What a deceitful yet clever scheme for world domination and setting up the stage for the mark of the beast!

The method of control and authority that enabled the Antichrist to rise to the highest power and authority given from Satan will only be intensified once the great tribulation begins, hence the Antichrist's mark carries such economic and monetary significance and impact over the world (Rev. 13:17). That is, through the Antichrist authority control over money, he blatantly takes away the ability for all people on earth to use money unless one receives the mark of the beast. As we all have taken for granted the universal right of the ability to use money, we have seldom, if ever, appreciated the utility of money's function or ever imagined living without money as a medium of exchange. As food for thought, imagine what life would be like living without using a medium of exchange for making economic transactions for a month: what should you take to the market to barter for food? How much of that "what" should you take without a proper unit of account concerning the price? Will the person selling the food accept "what" you are bartering for at the right time and place? What would it look like to pay for petrol or utilities with physical objects for both the buyer and the seller, rather than a single tap of a card or click of a button?

Without the function of a medium of exchange, we quickly find ourselves lining up at the petrol station trying to convince the owner why fish and lemons are just as valuable as cigarettes to trade for petrol. Saifadean Ammous, the author of the 'Bitcoin Standard' and economist from the Austrian school of economics, illustrates best in his book 'The Bitcoin Standard' why barter is not as desirable as many may think:

*Barter has always existed in human society and continues to this day, but it is highly impractical and remains only in use in exceptional circumstances, usually involving people with extensive familiarity with one another. In a more sophisticated and larger economy, the opportunity arises for individuals to specialise in the production of more goods and to exchange them with many more people - people with whom they have no personal*

*relationships, strangers with whom it is utterly impractical to keep a running tally of goods, services, and favours.*

*The problem is deeper than different requirements for different goods, as there are three distinct dimensions to the problem of bartering. First, there is the lack of coincidence in scales: what you want may not be equal in value to what you have and dividing one of them into smaller units may not be practical. Imagine wanting to sell shoes for a house; you cannot buy the house in small pieces each equivalent in value to a pair of shoes, nor does the homeowner want to own all the shoes whose value is equivalent to that of the house. Second, there is the lack of coincidence in time frames: what you want to sell may be perishable but what you want to buy is more durable, making it hard to accumulate enough of your perishable good to exchange for the more durable good at one point in time. It is not easy to accumulate enough apples to be exchanged for a car at once, because they will rot before the deal can be completed. Third, there is the lack of coincidence of locations: you may want to sell a house in one place to buy a house in another location, and (most) houses aren't transportable.*

*These three problems make direct exchange highly impractical and result in people needing to resort to performing more layers of exchange to satisfy their economic needs. The only way around this is through indirect exchange: you try to find some other good that another person would want and find someone who will exchange it with you for what you want to sell. That intermediary good is a medium of exchange [in other words, money, recognised by social consensus]. (2)*

The mark of the beast makes physical transactions (and going out physically in general) dangerous, as one would preferably not want to be in public without the mark of the beast under the Antichrist's government, due to how easily identifiable the mark makes to distinguish who is a loyal subject and who is not. With the punishment being caught without the mark being as severe as beheading (Rev. 20:4), it seems that bartering and all forms of transactions requiring the physical presence of the buyer and seller, such as the use of physical moneys, are altogether not a viable and sustainable solution to the mark of the beast.

## **Buyers and Sellers**

Another point to clarify before arriving at the solution is the emphasis on buying and selling. The key verse of this chapter, Revelation 13:17, says that no one may be able to buy or sell except having the mark of the beast, not just merely unable to buy, or not just merely unable to sell, but both. The explicit mention of both the actions of buying and selling in the same verse reveals that the consequences of the mark do not merely stop at an economic one regarding limits on trades, but in greater detail a monetary one concerning the use of money.

For as long as humans have begun to trade, there have always been ways to limit economic activities through placing certain restrictions and requirements on either the buying or the selling of goods. For example, a food-safety licence may limit the number of shops and restaurants

selling certain food and beverages, but consumers do not need a license to dine at a restaurant; therefore, the license is a form of restriction to selling, not buying. On the other hand, a pharmacy is always open during regular business hours, but to be able to purchase certain medications, one must have a doctor's prescription, as a restrictive requirement to buying, not selling. In fact, the imperial seal of the Neronian charagma and guild membership we analysed earlier were examples of requirements that affected either buying or selling, but not conclusively both. In order to definitively and conclusively restrict and control the ability and actions of both buying and selling simultaneously, one must control the underlying thing that anchors buying and selling together as two sides of the same coin: money. I believe with good reasons that the Antichrist will not try to impose restrictions on the buying or selling of every commodity and item and service in order to impede their buying or selling. Rather, by simply controlling money, he is able to all-inclusively have power over the buying and selling of everyone in everything.

Because the use of money as a medium of exchange facilitates the act of buying and selling simultaneously, with money, when one sells, another buys, and when one buys, another sells. One party cannot buy without another party selling. When money exists, buying and selling will always be two sides of the same coin. When using money to buy, or receiving money through a sale, the reciprocal action always occurs. Therefore, most unsurprisingly, to universally force everyone to receive the mark of the beast by universally depriving everyone's ability to buy or sell, the Antichrist achieves this through having full authority and control over money (more specifically, fiat money).

## **Arriving at a Solution**

### **Intermediaries, Counterparties, and Permission**

Money can be simply defined as a medium of exchange used between two or more parties for exchanging value, with the underlying object's monetary properties defining how well this neutral object (e.g. seashell, paper, gold) functions as money, which will be discussed in greater depth in the following chapter. Theoretically, any object can function as money, but not every object is accepted as money. Typically throughout human history, an object emerged to be money through organic social consensus due to its competitive monetary properties above other objects; the best examples are gold and silver, which emerged to function as money across all cultures and civilisations that had the capabilities to obtain them, not through a global decree, but due to their exceptional monetary properties. Throughout human history, many things have served the function of money: most notably gold and silver, but also copper, seashells, stones, salt, cattle, gems, and even toilet paper and cigarettes in certain conditions. People's, and by in large, societies' choices are subjective, and so there is no "right" and "wrong" choice of money. There are, however, consequences behind choices.

Today, fiat money has become synonymous with money, even replacing our concept of money as a whole. Generations of the 20th century grew up to believe money as a piece of paper or plastic issued by the government with a number, and generations after 21st century are growing up to believe money is a string of digital numbers told to us by a financial institution, we have rarely questioned why this particular piece of rectangular paper or this string of digits is worth the value that another party says it to be worth. The problem with money in today's age is that the underlying object that serves the function of money is wholly detached from the creation of God (refer to the list in the prior paragraph), to become subject to adulteration and manipulation by man. Money has become fiat (Latin for by decree, order, or authorisation), or fiat has become money replacing all other forms of moneys in today's times. A medium of exchange that emerged not due to social consensus, but enacted through decree, law, or authority by a person or a governing entity, whose value is dictated by its issuer, and the right to use is integrated upon layers and layers of permission.

The emergence of fiat money (or fiat currencies) in the latter half of the 20th century is an anomaly in human history, a global phenomenon no older than six decades (as of the time of writing), a time not long enough to make up 1% of human history, but long enough to replace our concept of money from something that is "hard" to fiat. Indeed, throughout history kingdoms and empires have decreed and issued their own currencies, but the value of those currencies, such as the Roman Denarius and the Lydian Stater pertains to the base metal; minting the faces of rulers on the coins proves to be no more than an act of regal vanity. If an emperor were to replace the base metal of an empire's coinage from gold to iron, but still forces everyone to accept the original face value of the coin, he would find himself in no small troubles. What differentiates "hard" from fiat is that for a coin with the same base metal and mass, the value of the coin does not change regardless of what number is stamped on it by anyone. For example, if you travel back 2000 years to the Roman Empire and stamp the number "2" on a Denarius silver coin, its value remains the same as any other single Denarius coin. If an item costs two Denarius coins, the merchant would not accept your single Denarius coin with the number "2" on it, he will require two coins for your purchase. However today, if the mint is to take the same two identical coins and stamp "1" on the first coin and "2" on the second coin, we accept the second coin is worth twice as much in value compared to the first coin.

It was only since the latter half of the 20th century that fiat has persisted and become universal, though it has appeared sporadically and locally in history. The practise and zeitgeist of fiat was pioneered by no other than Caesar Nero, being the first emperor to debase the Roman Empire's coinage by reducing the silver content of the Denarius while maintaining its face value by decree, shifting the basis of intrinsic economic value from of the silver Denarius from its metal content to the sovereign authority dictated by the emperor. Setting the precedent that the emperor could treat the currency as a flexible tool for policy and personal interest for his successors, and for the

monetary authorities of today’s times. By the late 3rd century, the Denarius was less than 5% silver. (3) It was essentially a base-metal coin that the empire forced people to accept at the value of silver, with disastrous consequences for the empire’s economy.

Objectively, the principle of fiat is manipulation and control, it is only with centralisation and authority that the value of something can be fixed and dictated by an authority. Going back to the problem of being unable to buy or sell without the mark of the beast, our current monetary system (or fiat system) has embedded layers of intermediaries, counterparties, and permission into all aspects of storing, transferring, and transacting with money in our daily lives.

The invention and adoption of fiat leads to a slippery slope that erodes away money’s sovereignty and adds more and more layers of permission and trust, beginning first with trusting the value of money would be upheld by its issuer, and then gradually surrendering one’s ownership by entrusting its custody to financial institutions, and then one’s ability to transact from the permission from payment processing intermediaries. The root problem with fiat money is all the trust that’s required to use it. The issuer must be trusted not to debase the currency, and the financial institutions must be trusted to honour our deposits to allow withdrawal and payments upon request. However, the history of fiat currencies has been one full of breaches of that trust.

The act of trusting counterparties in the storing and transferring of one’s money when the Antichrist takes control over the inhabited earth is analogous to allowing strangers to put their hands around one’s neck and trusting they will not choke one to death when they are coerced, pressured, threatened, or controlled by a greater authoritative figure. This is not to say that intermediaries and counterparties we entrust with the storage and transfer of our money are inherently malicious, but they, like any other human, are equally fallible and susceptible to act against the interests of their fiduciaries when theirs is at risk. Let us have a look through the intermediaries and counterparties involved in today’s typical day-to-day monetary transactions.

| Point-of-Sale Merchant Card Payment |          |                                                              |                                                |                                           |        |     |
|-------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------|-----|
| The Government                      |          |                                                              |                                                |                                           |        |     |
| Alice                               | Bank A → | Payment Gateway →<br>(e.g. Stripe, Paypal, Square, Windcave) | Payment Processor →<br>(e.g. Fiserv, Worldpay) | Card Network →<br>(e.g. Visa, Mastercard) | Bank B | Bob |

| Domestic Bank Transfer |          |                                                                |        |     |
|------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-----|
| The Government         |          |                                                                |        |     |
| Alice                  | Bank A → | Clearing House<br>→<br>(e.g. The Federal Reserve, Pay.UK, EBA) | Bank B | Bob |

The tables above, in a nutshell, show the typical process for a point-of-sale card payment with a merchant (top table) and a domestic bank transfer (bottom table) and the usual types and numbers of intermediaries/counterparties expected in the processing of each transaction with our current fiat monetary system. Taking Alice as the buyer and Bob as the seller in this economic transaction, in order to prevent both Alice and Bob from engaging in economic transactions with each other, that is, to buy and to sell, only one intermediary is needed to withhold permission to transact for either Alice or Bob in order to prevent Alice from using money and Bob from receiving. In addition, all fiat digital transactions occur in the backdrop of government supervision. Although the government does not directly take part in the transaction process, it possesses the greatest authority and influence over all parties involved in the transaction between Alice and Bob. Simple and effective methods can be requiring banks to freeze or confiscate the deposits of all persons who do not meet an arbitrary requirement (cf. Rev. 13:17). The conclusion is, we need a medium of exchange that can be transacted peer-to-peer, without needing permission and trust from any counterparties.

Prior to the advent of fiat moneys and digitalisation of money, transactions with physical moneys, which were predominantly precious metals, were conducted peer-to-peer, meaning money moved directly from the possession of Alice to Bob, from the buyer to the seller without any intermediaries and counterparties. When Alice goes to a market in Rome, she does not need to take her banker along to shop and ask her banker for permission to use her Denarius coins every time she completes a transaction. Transactions with physical moneys that occur face-to-face are peer-to-peer, and therefore occur on a permissionless and trustless basis (i.e., without the need for permission or trust) as there are no counterparties between the buyer and seller.

| Transacting with Physical Moneys |
|----------------------------------|
| Physical Threats                 |

|         |     |
|---------|-----|
| Alice → | Bob |
|---------|-----|

However, the fatal flaw of physical moneys is the fact that they are physical, and subject to threats and risks in the physical realm. Such threats and risks includes, and is not limited to government banning and interventions, such as the American President Franklin D. Roosevelt's Executive Order 6102, which prohibited the possession of gold coins and bullion by U.S. citizens, with penalties being up to 10 years in prison and \$10,000 fine in 1933, or the recall of Denarius coins by Roman mints authorised by Caesar Nero in the emperor's decree to debase the Roman coinage. Authorities could also enforce restrictions on the custody and carrying of physical moneys, as seen across airports and seaports that cap the value of physical precious metals and cash individuals can carry, despite the money being wholly and legally owned by the individual.

Furthermore, users of physical moneys are exposed to the same pitfalls that physical moneys are subject to. For example, the ban and confiscation of gold under the democratic government of President Franklin D. Roosevelt could equally (if not more) likely happen under the Antichrist; the restrictions on the movement of physical moneys could equally (if not more) likely to apply to persons without the mark of the beast, and merchants and service providers might not accept physical moneys at all, or not without some identification or having a physical covering over one's face. And even if one can sustain oneself by conducting economic transactions only with physical moneys, notwithstanding, the dangers of appearing physically in public without the mark of the beast would simply be too grave in a world under the authority of the Antichrist (cf. Rev. 20:4).

## Requirements for the Solution

Knowing that the satanic triad intends to deceive all people of the inhabited earth to receive the mark of the beast as a means to their survival through the controlling and granting of the right to use money. The practical solution for the majority of people still on the earth at the time of the great tribulation would be a medium of exchange that is not and cannot be controlled by the government, or by anyone at all, to ensure their own survival without the mark of the beast and to additionally take care of God's persecuted people during that time. Not through violence, but as a sly roundabout way, an exit to the current fiat monetary system that has been setting the stage for the mark of the beast.

Let us crystalise the points we have touched upon earlier concerning the necessary attributes of a medium of exchange that qualifies it to be a potential solution to the mark of the beast, in defeating the sole purpose and point of deception of the mark, the inability to buy or to sell, which is an essential necessity to survival in this age.

**Non-physical:** Physical moneys require its owner and user to physically store and use. This introduces immense dangers to its users with the risks of confiscation, such as outlawing, theft, or expropriation, and the need to travel physically, given how easily one can be identified with or without the mark of the beast. The threat of physical violence or arrest in a society under the control of the Antichrist simply makes physical moneys too dangerous and unsuitable for use. With malicious intentions, a \$5 hammer in person is more effective than a \$5 billion computer remotely in stopping someone from transacting.

**Global:** With authority and power over every tribe and people and tongue and nation, they intend to cause all, the small and the great, the rich and the poor, and the freemen and the slaves to receive the mark. Therefore, the medium of exchange must also be global in reach; universally available, accessible, recognised, and non-discriminatory to all, to the rich and the poor, the small and the great, to the people that one likes and the people that one doesn't like. Gold, in this regard, is the undefeated medium of exchange that is universally recognised and, for millennia of human history, the most widely used as money until the 20th century. Frustratingly, gold's only fatal flaw is that it is physical.

**Peer-to-Peer (Permissionless):** Anyone can send or receive it without asking a central authority or intermediaries for permission. This prevents gatekeepers from blocking transactions. The principle is simple: no gatekeepers to block transactions, so no transactions can be blocked.

**Self-custody:** A medium of exchange that is custodied and controlled directly by holders rather than custodial intermediaries (e.g. banks and exchanges). If you hold it, others can't freeze it. The shift from decentralised self-custody to centralised custodial intermediaries unsurprisingly parallels the transition from hard to fiat money over the past century. When God ordained precious metals to function as media of exchange for the children of Israel, He also intended for them to be decentralised and self-custodied by individuals and families (cf. Exo. 22:7; Deut. 14:25-26; Prov. 21:20), rather than to be entrusted to centralised financial authorities such as the money changers (John 2:15), who were the precursors to modern bankers.

**Seizure resistant:** The medium of exchange should be hard to confiscate without the holder's cooperation, as the ability to seize or freeze one's funds will render it unusable for its owner in transacting, regardless of the quantity of funds. Bearer instruments like cash or gold are seizure-resistant if physically hidden, while cryptographic custody resists all forms of seizure unless the cryptographic network is under centralised control or one surrenders access to their funds.

**Decentralised:** Decentralisation of a (monetary) network means no single party (individual, entity, corporation, or government) can unilaterally decide which transactions are valid and which are not. A medium of exchange of a decentralised network should have no central issuer, no

rulers, no gatekeepers, and no gates to keep. Greater decentralisation in a monetary network indicates higher resistance to hostile takeovers and censorship.

**Private:** For digital media of exchange, privacy is of utmost importance for user safety. For physical moneys, transactions are traceless and any records are kept localised and decentralised. Without privacy, users become targetable. Information from transactions could be easily linked to one's personal identity and sensitive personal information, especially one's location. Given all the attributes above, the utility of the medium of exchange would fall void if the safety of its users could not be guaranteed. Again, \$5 hammer in person beats a \$5 billion computer remotely in this regard.

|                       | Fiat moneys (digital) | Fiat moneys (physical) | Gold (physical & non-fiat) |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------------|
| Non-physical          | Green                 | Red                    | Red                        |
| Global                | Yellow                | Red                    | Green                      |
| Peer-to-peer          | Red                   | Green                  | Green                      |
| Permissionless to use | Red                   | Green                  | Green                      |
| Self-custody          | Red                   | Green                  | Green                      |
| Seizure resistant     | Red                   | Red                    | Red                        |
| Decentralised         | Red                   | Red                    | Yellow                     |
| Private               | Red                   | Green                  | Green                      |

Assessing each type of money we currently have at our disposal based on these attributes, it becomes clear that each has its own pitfalls that make it and its users vulnerable to economic censorship. Digital fiat moneys exchange one's sovereignty for the convenience of use, while physical moneys, like cash or precious metals, makes it unwieldy and potentially dangerous to use in the context discussed in this chapter. Fiat cash is akin to arcade tokens around the globe, only able to have recognised value and be spent within the jurisdiction of its issuer, while precious metals, though recognised globally, are highly impractical for individuals to transact globally (over long distances) without involving third parties.

Given the fallibility of the media of exchange we currently have at our disposal, does this mean all hope is lost for the people still dwelling on the earth when the Antichrist comes? Will they have to either receive the mark of the beast or face certain deprivation with no ability to buy or to sell? The

answer would be yes, there would be almost no chance for the vast majority of people dwelling on earth to survive for more than three years without the ability to buy or to sell in the 21st century, and it is because of this fact, the satanic triad is scheming to deceive as many people as possible into receiving the mark of the beast (Rev. 19:20) to perish alongside them in the lake of fire.

HOWEVER, if no medium of exchange existed (and continues to exist) as a solution that annuls the mark of the beast at the time of writing, the author would not have picked up the pen and keyboard to write this very book. Before 2008, the author would also have been as clueless as most about the mark of the beast and what people around the world should do to immunise themselves against it. But 2008 saw the genesis of a new medium of exchange that possesses all of the attributes required to be the solution to the mark of the beast. A peaceful roundabout way that took the control of money away from the hands of the government.

## **Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System**

In 2008, an anonymous individual known by the pseudonym Satoshi Nakamoto published a white paper on a cryptographic peer-to-peer digital cash system called Bitcoin. In this white paper, the unknown creator of Bitcoin established its original and the only intention to function as a purely peer-to-peer digital medium of exchange in a decentralised network that enables transactions to be sent directly from one party to another without going through or needing the permission of an intermediary financial institution.

*I've been working on a new electronic cash system that's fully peer-to-peer, with no trusted third party.*

*– Satoshi Nakamoto, 2008 (4)*

Satoshi identified the concern in 2008 that commerce and transactions have come to rely almost exclusively on financial institutions serving as gatekeepers and trusted third parties in the transacting and storing of our money. Although the current system functions well enough for most transactions, it, and by and large its participants, suffer from the inherent weaknesses of the trust-based model. Though, as of now, in developed nations we perceive minimal consequences from such trust-based payment systems, the effect would be critical and immediate if the third parties could no longer be trusted to act in the best interests of the participants of the system.

Prior to the invention of Bitcoin, no mechanism existed to store and transact economic value digitally and without a trusted third party. Culminating from four decades of research and development in cryptography, Satoshi was able to develop a digital payment system based on cryptographic verification instead of trust, allowing any two willing parties to transact directly with each other without the need to trust each other or a third party. By removing these intermediaries,

Satoshi effectively eliminated the centralised checkpoints that authorities traditionally use to monitor and restrict economic transactions.

The potential weaponisation of such centralised access is vividly illustrated in the prophetic word of Revelation chapter 13, which portrays the future in which those who do not comply with receiving the mark of the beast are excluded from economic activities essential to survival in today's age. In contemporary terms, it starkly warns of the ability of centralised financial and political institutions to deny individuals access to financial services. The practical consequences of such exclusion could not be more emphasised: without the ability and means to transact, people across the globe risk losing access to essential goods and services, forcing those ignorant of the mark's most grievous consequences into receiving it.

Against this backdrop, we have come to know that a solution is much needed for the majority of people still dwelling on the earth at the appearing of the Antichrist; a monetary system that is wholly outside, indifferent, and immune to authority and control, a medium of exchange bypassing financial institutions and systems and rendering the mark's design of economic coercion useless by ensuring the right and freedom to store and transact value. As the power of the mark lies in its ability to prevent, censor, and control economic activities, so too does the power of Bitcoin lie in its inability to do the same. Because Bitcoin as a medium of exchange is borderless, permissionless, and resistant to censorship and control, it fundamentally undermines the power dynamics required for the mark of the beast to function. By providing a parallel, globally available monetary system that anyone can access anytime, and that cannot be coerced, controlled, confiscated, or turned off, Bitcoin offers a permanent and voluntary opt-out from a system designed to enforce total economic compliance.

Permissionless and decentralised networks are difficult to take over or shut down universally, and the ability to hold and transfer value without intermediaries means preventing transactions requires physical coercive access to the parties of the transaction rather than merely an administrative order to an intermediary. As a result, the mark of the beast loses its incentive and leverage; if people can transact freely outside of state or institutionally controlled rails, then denying access to those rails will not prevent one from transacting and offers little to no incentive for receiving the mark of the beast.

As peer-to-peer networks wholly outside the operations and control of modern financial, monetary, and political systems, Bitcoin (and similar decentralised networks) constitute a genuine countermeasure and escape from state coercion and economic exclusion. The author recognises that technology alone cannot unilaterally resolve the full set of complex political, social, and legal dynamics that underlie the global situation during the Antichrist's final three-and-a-half-year reign, and the efficacy of an alternative monetary network such as Bitcoin (or any technology in general) depends on sufficient adoption and user education. Nonetheless, Bitcoin

remains the sharpest tool in humanity's shed for peacefully resisting any and all forms of financial and economic coercion, control, or censorship destined to take place in the world at the coming of the Antichrist and the mark of the beast.